

Interrogation Record: Halvard Sablewood

The following account is entered in the black register. The place of examination is not recorded. The names of the questioning officers are likewise absent. Ink has run across the lower margin, and several lines have been struck through.

QUESTIONER: State your name.

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: Halvard Sablewood.

QUESTIONER: Your office?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: Scribe.

QUESTIONER: You serve as a scribe?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: That is what is written.

QUESTIONER: What do you write?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: What is placed before me.

QUESTIONER: Do you write what is true?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: I write what is commanded. Truth is not always supplied with the parchment.

[A pause is marked here. The sound of a chair being moved is noted in the margin, though by whose hand is uncertain.]

QUESTIONER: You were born in what year?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: 408 AS.

QUESTIONER: Speak clearly. You were born in 408 AS?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: Yes.

QUESTIONER: And now you stand before the Ashen Era's authorities as what?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: A scribe.

QUESTIONER: Not a captain. Not a lord. Not a herald of any power.

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: I did not claim to be any of those.

QUESTIONER: Your insignia?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: I bear none that I know.

QUESTIONER: Your allegiance?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: The page before me, while I am writing upon it.

QUESTIONER: Is that an answer?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: It is the answer I can give.

[Here the record changes hands. The next lines are written in a narrower script.]

SECOND QUESTIONER: Halvard Sablewood, you are described in the rolls as a minor figure of the Ashen Era. Do you dispute this description?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: I have not seen the rolls.

SECOND QUESTIONER: Do you dispute it?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: I do not know enough to dispute it.

SECOND QUESTIONER: Why have you concealed your face?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: I have concealed nothing.

[A note beneath this exchange reads: "No canonical physical details are recorded." Whether this is an official finding or a later correction cannot be determined.]

SECOND QUESTIONER: You appear to be calm.

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: Do I?

SECOND QUESTIONER: Your demeanor is unrecorded.

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: Then record only that I answered.

SECOND QUESTIONER: What will you do when released?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: If I am released, I will serve as a scribe.

SECOND QUESTIONER: And if you are not?

HALVARD SABLEWOOD: Then the page will remain unfinished.

No confession is entered. No sentence is entered. The final leaf bears Halvard Sablewood's mark, though whether it is a signature or merely a scribe's notation is not explained.